WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

GREECE

Europe

Information current as of November 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Athens and Attica	Capital and economic centre; seat of government, the Bank of Greece and most international firms, with a growing technology and services sector	Finance, IT, real estate, tourism, business services
Ellinikon (former Athens airport)	Greece's largest urban regeneration project, where about 1,000 homes have been sold, the Riviera Tower is due for completion around the turn of 2026–27 and first homes will be handed over in 2027	Real estate, retail, hospitality, construction
Piraeus	Greece's main port and a major Mediterranean container and ferry hub, centre of the Greek shipping industry	Shipping, port logistics, maritime services
Thessaloniki and northern Greece	Second city and port, serving the Balkans and linking to energy corridors running north to Bulgaria and beyond	Logistics, manufacturing, energy, technology
Offshore south of Crete and the Peloponnese	Four blocks covering about 47,000 sq km awarded to Chevron (70%) and HELLENiQ ENERGY (30%) in February 2026 for gas exploration	Upstream energy, offshore services, seismic surveys
Crete and the Aegean islands	Leading tourism destinations, with premium real estate subject to the higher €800,000 golden-visa threshold in high-demand islands	Tourism and hospitality, real estate, renewables

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Enterprise Greece, the national investment and trade promotion agency, offers investor facilitation and aftercare
- Strategic Investments procedure, now handled by the Ministry of Development's General Secretariat for Private Investments under Law 5297/2026, offering fast-track licensing and support for large projects
- Development and EU state-aid incentives, including the framework under which the Metlen gallium project receives €118 million in grants and tax incentives
- Corporate income tax of 22%, with a tonnage tax regime for shipping
- Euro-area membership: the euro is the national currency and the Bank of Greece is part of the Eurosystem, with free capital movement under EU rules

- Residence by investment (golden visa) for real estate from €800,000 in high-demand areas, €400,000 elsewhere and €250,000 for conversions and listed-building restoration
- EU co-financing through the €35.95 billion Greece 2.0 Recovery and Resilience Plan, the largest relative to GDP in the EU, and cohesion funds

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Greece in November 2026 is one of the euro area's strongest turnaround stories, combining steady growth, large budget surpluses and record foreign investment. GDP grew 2.1% in 2025 and 1.9% year-on-year in the second quarter of 2026, and the 2027 draft budget forecasts 2.0% growth this year and 2.3% next, with investment rising 7.9%. Foreign direct investment reached a record €12.6 billion in 2025 and €7.6 billion in January–July 2026, almost double the same period of 2025, led by banking, energy and real estate. The primary surplus was 4.9% of GDP in 2025, and early repayment of bailout loans is cutting debt rapidly. Scope raised Greece to BBB+ and Moody's assigned a positive outlook in September 2026, and Chevron's entry into offshore exploration in February 2026 signals new energy potential.

Greece's main structural challenge is its high public debt, together with inflation that has risen above the euro-area average. Debt was 146.1% of GDP in 2025, still the highest in the EU, and inflation reached 5.1% in September 2026, driven by accommodation, air fares and energy. The trend is firmly positive: the government projects debt falling to 136.8% of GDP in 2026 and 128.8% in 2027, a cumulative fall of 67 percentage points since 2020, supported by primary surpluses and early loan repayments. Euro membership and ECB policy, with the deposit rate at 2.5%, anchor financing conditions, and the final Recovery Plan payment requests submitted in September 2026 will unlock up to €6.75 billion, sustaining opportunities in energy, infrastructure, digital and tourism.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
High public debt	Debt was 146.1% of GDP in 2025, the highest in the EU, keeping the state sensitive to interest rates	Debt is falling fast on primary surpluses and early repayments; rating upgrades are lowering funding costs over time
Inflation and cost pressures	Inflation reached 5.1% in September 2026 and the Bank of Greece expects 3.5% for 2026 as a whole	ECB policy anchors prices; build energy and wage scenarios into plans and consider energy-efficiency investment
End of Recovery Plan funding	Recovery Plan disbursements end after the final payment requests submitted in September 2026	The budget still forecasts 7.9% investment growth in 2027, and cohesion funds continue to co-finance projects
Election in spring 2027	The Prime Minister has said the next general election will be held on time in spring 2027, with a reshaped opposition including a new party led by Alexis Tsipras	Broad consensus on EU membership and fiscal discipline limits policy risk; track party programmes on tax and investment
Licensing and judicial delays	Permitting and court processes can be slow for complex projects	Use the Strategic Investments fast-track procedure and experienced local advisers
Higher golden-visa thresholds	Higher thresholds in Attica, Thessaloniki and popular islands contributed to the first fall in real-estate FDI since 2020	Conversion and restoration routes from €250,000 and lower thresholds elsewhere create new opportunities
Eastern Mediterranean geopolitics	Maritime boundary questions in the Eastern Mediterranean can affect offshore energy and cable projects	As an EU and NATO member, Greece benefits from collective security; include project-specific contingencies in planning

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Greece's risk profile is that of a euro-area member that has completed a strong fiscal and economic recovery, with large primary surpluses, record foreign investment and steadily improving credit ratings. Scope's upgrade to BBB+ and Moody's positive outlook in September 2026, and S&P's affirmation of BBB in October 2026, reflect fiscal discipline and falling debt. The main issues are high public debt, which remains the highest in the EU although falling rapidly, and inflation of 5.1% in September 2026, both being addressed within the EU and euro-area framework. The government led by Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis has ruled out an early election, with a vote

expected in spring 2027. No sanctions or legal restrictions materially limit investment in Greece, and investors benefit from the legal certainty of EU law and the convenience of the euro.

MARKET ACCESS

As a member of the EU, Greece gives investors tariff-free access to the EU single market and to all the EU's free trade agreements, with WTO membership and the EU's common trade policy governing trade with third countries. The euro removes exchange-rate costs for trade with euro-area partners, and Schengen membership allows passport-free travel across most of the EU. Greece sits at the crossroads of Europe, Asia and Africa: Piraeus is a major Mediterranean port and the centre of Greek shipping, and Thessaloniki serves the Balkan hinterland. In energy, Greek LNG terminals feed gas northwards to Bulgaria and beyond through the Vertical Gas Corridor, and offshore exploration south of Crete could add domestic supply, positioning Greece as a regional energy gateway.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis)	Sets economic, fiscal and reform policy; the New Democracy government has ruled out an early election, with a vote expected in spring 2027	Primary reference point for Greece's strategic direction and major projects
Enterprise Greece	National investment and trade promotion agency supporting foreign investors and exporters	Standard first point of contact for market entry
Ministry of Development (General Secretariat for Private Investments)	Evaluates Strategic Investments applications and administers development incentives	Key counterpart for large projects seeking fast-track status and state aid
Bank of Greece	Member of the Eurosystem whose governor sits on the ECB Governing Council; supervises banks within the Single Supervisory Mechanism	Relevant for banking, payments and financial-sector matters
Ministry of National Economy and Finance	Leads the budget, tax policy, debt management and the Recovery and Resilience Plan	Key counterpart on tax, fiscal and EU-funding matters
HELLENiQ ENERGY	Leading Greek refiner and Chevron's 30% partner in four offshore exploration blocks	Partner for upstream, refining and energy-transition engagement
Public Power Corporation (PPC)	Greece's largest power utility, which raised €4.25 billion in new capital in 2026 with participation from CVC Capital Partners	Essential partner for power, renewables and grid-related investment

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American-Hellenic Chamber of Commerce, the British Hellenic Chamber of Commerce, the German-Hellenic Chamber of Industry and Commerce and the Athens Chamber of Commerce and Industry are the main business associations, while the Hellenic Federation of Enterprises (SEV) represents domestic industry. Enterprise Greece holds investor events and promotes Greece at international forums, and the annual Thessaloniki International Fair is a key platform for government economic announcements. The European Investment Bank, the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development and EU-funded programmes managed by national ministries offer co-financing for energy, infrastructure and private-sector projects. Embassies of major EU partners, the UK and the US maintain commercial sections that are a useful source of introductions.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Greece suits investors seeking a growing euro-area market with improving credit fundamentals: real-estate and hospitality investors in Athens, Ellinikon and the islands; energy investors in renewables, grids, LNG and offshore exploration; shipping and logistics companies using Piraeus and Thessaloniki; financial investors following the

record flows into Greek banks and utilities; manufacturers in metals and critical raw materials using the Strategic Investments procedure; and technology and services companies drawing on Athens' talent pool.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Enterprise Greece and the Ministry of Development
Open dialogue on facilitation, development incentives and eligibility for the Strategic Investments fast-track procedure.

STEP 2: Map sector and location opportunities
Compare Athens, Ellinikon, Thessaloniki, the ports and the islands against sector priorities, incentives and golden-visa thresholds.

STEP 3: Identify remaining EU funding
Assess final Recovery Plan disbursements and cohesion programmes that can co-finance energy, digital, infrastructure or tourism components.

STEP 4: Plan for costs and the 2027 election
Build inflation and energy-price assumptions into models and track party programmes ahead of the spring 2027 election.

STEP 5: Position for energy and infrastructure projects
Follow offshore exploration, grid and renewables tenders, and partner with leading Greek groups such as HELLENiQ ENERGY and PPC.